

KAYAN

Partnerships & Funding Strategy

Who matters, what they hold, and how Kayan approaches each — strategically and in sequence

Kayan Innovation, Entrepreneurship & Work Environments LLC

Aden, Yemen · KAY-STR-PART-001 · CONFIDENTIAL

«خلف كلِّ مشروعٍ ناجحٍ، كيان» · *Behind every successful project, a Kayan.*

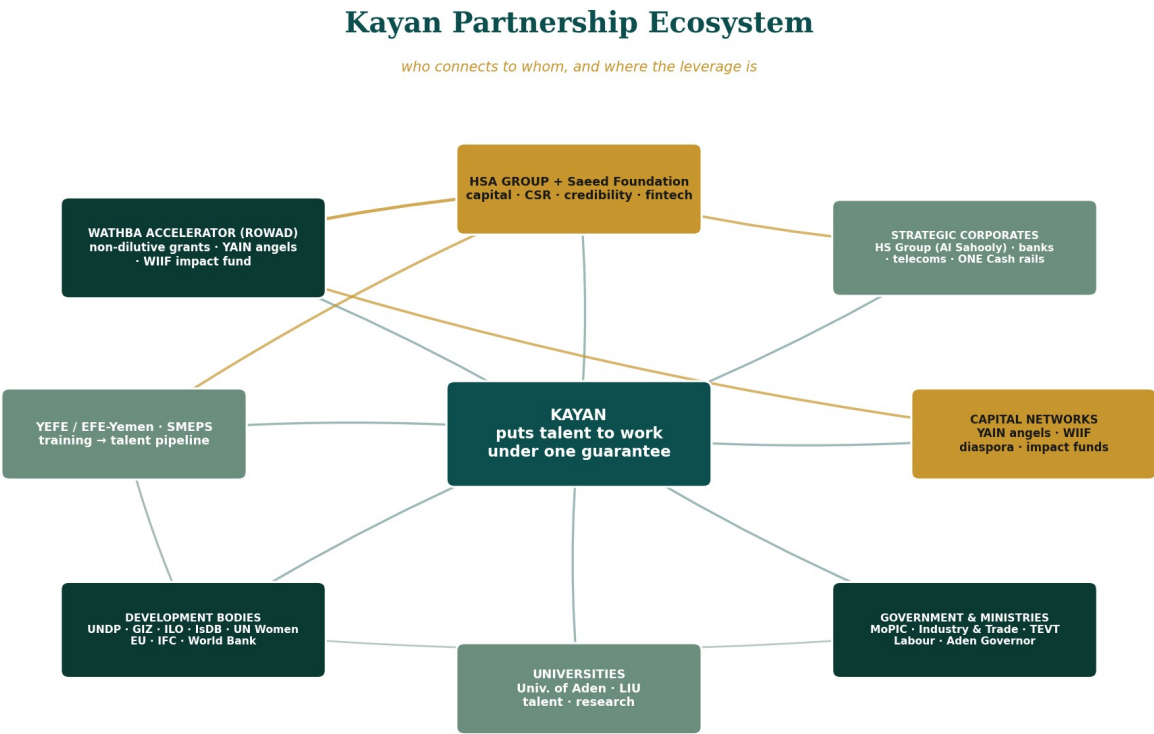
1 • Purpose & Partnership Philosophy

Kayan does not stand alone. It sits inside a Yemeni ecosystem of corporates, foundations, accelerators, development bodies, training institutions, universities, banks and government — many of which are already trying to solve the very problem Kayan was built for: putting Yemeni talent to work. This strategy maps that ecosystem, identifies who matters, sets out what each holds and what Kayan offers in return, and defines exactly how and when to approach each one.

The philosophy is deliberate. Kayan approaches partners as a peer with something real to offer — a governed, revenue-generating institution that delivers measurable placements under a trust guarantee — not as a supplicant asking for help. Every partnership must be mutual: Kayan gains capital, credibility, talent or reach; the partner advances its own mission through Kayan's delivery. Partnerships that are not mutual are not pursued.

The strategic insight: this ecosystem is tightly interconnected, and one institution sits near its centre — the Hayel Saeed Anam (HSA) Group, which co-funds the WATHBA accelerator, sits on the board of Yemen Education for Employment, and runs the Al-Saeed Foundation. Win credibility with the right node, and much of the network opens. The highest-leverage single entry is the WATHBA accelerator, run by ROWAD — non-dilutive grants plus direct access to angel investors and an impact fund.

2 • The Ecosystem at a Glance



Gold lines = HSA's gravitational pull through the ecosystem · Teal lines = Kayan's direct relationships · Highest-leverage entry: WATHBA (grants + investor access)

Kayan groups its partners into eight categories. Each plays a distinct role; together they supply the capital, talent, credibility and reach the institution needs across its phases.

#	PARTNER CATEGORY	WHAT KAYAN SEEKS FROM IT	PRIORITY
A	Anchor corporates & foundations (HSA, Saeed Foundation, HS Group)	Capital, CSR sponsorship, anchor clients, credibility	Highest
B	Accelerators & ecosystem builders (WATHBA/ROWAD, SMEPS/SFD)	Non-dilutive grants, mentorship, investor access	Highest
C	Capital & investor networks (YAIN, WIIF, diaspora)	Equity and impact investment	High
D	Development & multilateral bodies (UNDP, GIZ, ILO, IsDB, UN Women, EU, IFC)	Blended capital, programme funding, legitimacy	High
E	Training & employment institutions (YEFE/EFE-Yemen, Re:Coded)	A trained-talent pipeline into the registry	High
F	Universities (University of Aden, Lebanese International University)	Talent, research, internships, credibility	Medium
G	Government & ministries (MoPIC, Industry & Trade, TEVT, Labour, Aden authority)	Licences, accreditation, legitimacy, access to funds	Ongoing
H	Civil society & community (for Kayan for Yemen)	Reach and impact delivery for the civic brand	Medium

3 · Priority Partner Profiles — Who They Are, What They Hold, How to Approach

Each profile sets out the partner's focus, what they have in hand, what Kayan offers in return, and the specific approach — when, how and what to ask. Owners are named so every relationship has a single point of accountability.

Hayel Saeed Anam (HSA) Group & Al-Saeed Foundation مجموعة هائل

سعيد أنعم ومؤسسة السعيد

Focus: Yemen's largest private conglomerate (est. 1938; 70+ companies; ~35,000 staff). Stated philosophy: build capacity so people 'live a decent life without relying on aid.' Strong CSR via the Al-Saeed Foundation for Science & Culture (est. 1996) and UN-partnered humanitarian work. Ventures in renewable energy, IT and fintech (ONE Cash / Murooj).

What they hold: Capital; deep credibility; nationwide networks; CSR and foundation budgets; demand for talent across 70+ companies; payment-rail technology; convening power across the whole ecosystem.

What Kayan offers: A turnkey way to deliver their 'capacity over aid' mission with measurable placements; a verified talent pipeline for their own companies; a flagship CSR partnership rooted in Aden; values alignment they can point to.

► **APPROACH:** Build the relationship now, make the big ask after soft-open proof. Warm path: via the WATHBA/ROWAD connection (HSA co-funds it) or via HSA's representative on the YEFE board. Lead with mission alignment + measurable impact. Three asks, sequenced: (1) Al-Saeed Foundation grant/sponsorship for Kayan Forge; (2) HSA as an anchor client for Managed Delivery; (3) a strategic CSR partnership and possible fintech-rail collaboration (ONE Cash). OWNER: CEO.

WATHBA Accelerator — run by ROWAD Foundation مسرعة وثبة

مؤسسة رواد

Focus: An intensive accelerator for early-stage Yemeni startups, funded by the EU Delegation to Yemen and HSA, implemented by ROWAD Foundation with DeepRoot Consulting. ROWAD (est. 2013) is Yemen's leading entrepreneurship-ecosystem builder.

What they hold: Non-dilutive financial grants; mentorship and masterclasses; investment-readiness training; and — critically — direct access to the Yemeni Angel Investors Network (YAIN) and the Wathba Impact Investment Fund (WIIF). Plus credibility and a national network.

What Kayan offers: A strong, governed, fundable venture that makes the accelerator look good — a portfolio star with real revenue, real governance, and a clear social mission.

► **APPROACH:** This is the single highest-leverage move. APPLY to the next WATHBA cohort. Kayan is unusually ready: the Business Plan, Financial Model and Investment Memorandum are already built to investor standard. Prepare and submit the application; use acceptance to access YAIN and WIIF for the seed round. Note ROWAD is Sana'a-based but operates nationally, so engage remotely and through Aden ecosystem contacts. WHEN: next open cohort — treat as a standing priority. OWNER: CEO + Finance Lead.

Yemen Education for Employment (YEFE / EFE-Yemen) مؤسسة اليمن

للتدريب بهدف التوظيف

Focus: A business-backed civil-society organisation (est. 2008) tackling youth unemployment by bridging education and the private sector — training young Yemenis and placing them into jobs. Active in Aden (the 'Mustaqbal' project graduated 500 youth in 2025), funded by IFC and Alwaleed Philanthropies, with an HSA Group director on its board.

What they hold: A pipeline of trained, job-ready youth; employer networks; market-driven curricula; monitoring & evaluation systems; and donor relationships.

What Kayan offers: The employer / placement end of their pipeline — the thing training programmes most struggle to secure. YEFE graduates can flow into Kayan's registry and Kayan Forge, then into paid work under the guarantee. Kayan turns their 'trained' into 'employed.'

► **APPROACH:** Engage now — this directly feeds the talent supply chain. Propose a placement partnership: Kayan as a named destination for YEFE graduates, with a co-designed 'training-to-placement' track and Kayan Forge complementing (not duplicating) their curriculum. WHEN: Phase 1. OWNER: Delivery Lead / Forge Lead.

Development & Multilateral Bodies الجهات التنموية والدولية

Focus: UNDP (economic recovery / SIERY), GIZ Yemen (private-sector & employment), ILO (ERRY — resilience & livelihoods), IsDB (BRAVE — women & SMEs), UN Women (LEAP — women's economic empowerment), plus the EU, IFC and World Bank. All fund livelihoods, youth employment, SME development and resilience.

What they hold: Programme funding and blended capital; legitimacy; rigorous M&E frameworks; and reach.

What Kayan offers: A private-sector delivery vehicle for their livelihoods and youth-employment targets — with placement built into the business model and measurement built into the systems. Kayan can implement components they would otherwise contract to less sustainable NGOs.

► **APPROACH:** Position Kayan as an implementing / delivery partner for employment and livelihoods components, not a grantee. This needs the Social Impact Framework (next document) to articulate measurement in their language. WHEN: Phase 1–2, after first placements give proof. OWNER: CEO + Government Lead.

Universities — University of Aden & Lebanese International University جامعة عدن والجامعة اللبنانية الدولية

Focus: Talent pipeline, research, and credibility. The University of Aden is the local anchor; the Lebanese International University (LIU) is connected to the ecosystem through ROWAD's leadership, who lectures there.

What they hold: Students and graduates; faculty and research; facilities; and academic credibility.

What Kayan offers: Real, paid work and internships for students; a visible path from study to employment; applied projects for faculty; and a private-sector partner for accreditation and placement statistics.

► **APPROACH:** Sign MoUs for internships and a talent pipeline; offer guest lectures and applied-project partnerships. University of Aden first (local, Phase 1); LIU via the ROWAD warm path (Phase 2). OWNER: Forge Lead / People Lead.

Government & Ministries الحكومة والوزارات

Focus: MoPIC (Planning & International Cooperation — the gateway to development funding and partnership registration); Ministry of Industry & Trade (commercial licensing); Ministry of Technical Education & Vocational Training (accreditation for Kayan Forge); Ministry of Labour / Social Affairs (employment & social insurance); and the Aden local authority / Governor (local legitimacy, permits, the Governor patronised the YEFE graduation).

What they hold: Licences, accreditation and legitimacy; convening power; and access to development-funding channels.

What Kayan offers: A governed, tax-paying, job-creating institution that advances the government's own employment agenda — with measurable outcomes it can showcase.

► **APPROACH:** Keep impeccably compliant; pursue TEVT accreditation for Kayan Forge; register with MoPIC for development-partner eligibility; invite the Aden Governor to the launch. WHEN: ongoing, from now. OWNER: Government Lead (Ali Qaed).

4 • The Approach Playbook — Who First, and Why

Sequence matters. Kayan approaches partners in an order that builds momentum: secure the talent pipeline and non-dilutive capital first, prove delivery, then convert proof into bigger corporate and development relationships. Each step makes the next easier.

ORDER	MOVE	WHY NOW	OWNER
1	Apply to WATHBA (ROWAD)	Highest leverage: non-dilutive grant + access to YAIN angels & WIIF for the seed	CEO + Finance
2	Partner with YEFE / EFE-Yemen	Secures the trained-talent pipeline that feeds delivery from day one	Delivery/Forge Lead
3	MoU with University of Aden	Local talent & internships; credibility; low cost	Forge/People Lead
4	Government groundwork (MoPIC, TEVT, Aden authority)	Compliance, accreditation & eligibility for development funds; invite Governor to launch	Government Lead
5	Deepen HS Group (Al Sahooley) from client to advocate	Already engaged; convert to reference client & sponsor	CEO/Delivery Lead
6	Approach HSA & Al-Saeed Foundation	After soft-open proof: the big CSR/anchor-client/foundation ask	CEO
7	Engage development bodies (UNDP/GIZ/ILO/IsDB/UN Women)	After first placements + Social Impact Framework give fundable proof	CEO + Government Lead
8	Activate capital networks (YAIN, WIIF, diaspora)	Via WATHBA and the Investment Memorandum, to close the seed	CEO + Finance

The warm-path principle: wherever possible, reach a partner through someone who already trusts them. WATHBA opens HSA and the investor networks; YEFE shares an HSA board member; ROWAD connects to LIU. Map the warm path before any cold approach.

5 • What Kayan Brings to the Table

Partnerships are mutual. Kayan is not asking for charity — it offers partners something each of them wants:

- **To investors & accelerators:** a governed, revenue-generating institution with real controls — safe to fund and to be associated with.
- **To corporates & foundations:** measurable placements and capacity-building that deliver their mission better than aid — the 'capacity over dependency' outcome they seek.

- **To development bodies:** a private-sector delivery partner with built-in measurement for livelihoods and youth-employment targets.
- **To training institutions:** the employer at the end of the pipeline — turning 'trained' into 'employed.'
- **To universities:** real paid work and a study-to-employment path for students.
- **To government:** a tax-paying, job-creating institution that advances the national employment agenda.

6 • Funding Strategy — The Capital Stack

Kayan builds a layered capital stack so it is never dependent on any single source. Each layer carries part of the load and de-risks the others.

LAYER	SOURCE	ROLE	WHEN
Earned revenue	Clients (Delivery, Hub, Café)	The base; recognised only when earned	From soft-open
Non-dilutive	WATHBA grants; accelerator awards; competitions	Extends runway without giving up equity	Now → Phase 1
Equity (seed)	YAIN angels, WIIF, diaspora, direct IPS	Funds Phase-1 completion & the track record	2026
Blended / programme	UNDP, GIZ, ILO, IsDB, UN Women, EU, IFC	Funds the talent pipeline & impact at scale	Phase 1–2
Strategic / CSR	HSA, Al-Saeed Foundation, corporates	Sponsorship + anchor demand + credibility	After proof
Equity (Series A)	Impact & regional funds	Scales the platform	Q2 2027

Investment consultant's note: the smartest near-term money is non-dilutive. Winning a WATHBA grant and a competition or two extends runway and de-risks the seed without touching the cap table — and the same process introduces the angels and impact fund who write the equity cheque. Pursue non-dilutive and equity in parallel, through the same door.

7 • Operationalization — Owning the Relationships

Every partner has one accountable owner at Kayan, a clear next action, and a review cadence. Relationships are tracked in a partnerships pipeline (a companion tracker) and reviewed monthly by the CEO.

RELATIONSHIP CLUSTER	OWNER	CONTRIBUTES	CADENCE
Corporates, foundations, the seed (HSA, investors)	CEO	Finance Lead	Monthly
Accelerators & competitions (WATHBA/ROWAD)	CEO + Finance Lead	Brand Lead	Per cohort

Talent pipeline (YEFE, universities)	Delivery / Forge Lead	People Lead	Monthly
Development bodies	CEO + Government Lead	Finance Lead	Quarterly
Government & accreditation	Government Lead	CEO	Ongoing
Civil society (Kayan for Yemen)	People Lead	CEO	Quarterly

■ Governing policies & forms for partnerships

- Partnership / MoU template — the standard instrument for every partner
- AML/CFT & KYC Policy (KAY-LEG-016) — due diligence on every partner & funder
- Anti-Fraud & COI Policy (KAY-GOV-006) — related-party & gift screening
- Governance Charter (KAY-GOV-002) — partnerships above thresholds are a reserved matter
- Grant & fund compliance checklist — donor reporting & restricted-funds handling
- Partnerships Pipeline tracker — the live CRM of every relationship (to be built)

8 • Risks & Mitigations

RISK	MITIGATION
Over-dependence on one partner (e.g., HSA)	Build a diversified stack; no single partner > a set share of funding
Mission drift to chase grants	Only pursue funding that fits the model; the guarantee and the four lines are non-negotiable
Geographic split (many bodies Sana'a-based; Kayan in Aden)	Engage remotely; use Aden-active programmes (YEFE Mustaqbal) and the Aden authority
Politicisation / neutrality	Stay strictly apolitical; work across the ecosystem; let delivery speak
Donor compliance burden	KYC, restricted-funds discipline, and reporting built into the Finance system from the start
Slow institutional timelines	Pursue several tracks in parallel; never let one slow partner stall the plan

9 • Where This Narrative Travels

This strategy is the master map, but the partnership narrative must flow into the documents that face each audience. The cross-references below keep one story consistent everywhere.

DOCUMENT	WHAT IT INHERITS FROM HERE
Business Plan	An ecosystem / partnerships section naming the key relationships and the warm paths
Investment Memorandum	WATHBA, YAIN and WIIF as investor-access routes; blended

	& non-dilutive capital as de-risking
Go-to-Market & Launch	Partners as launch channels; the Aden Governor and partners at the launch event
Kayan Forge OS	YEFE, universities and TEVT as the training-and-accreditation pipeline
Social Impact Framework	Development bodies' measurement language; the impact case that unlocks blended capital

Recommendation logged to the Review Log: thread specific partner references into the Business Plan, Investment Memorandum and Forge OS as relationships mature, so each document speaks to its audience with the right names — while this strategy remains the single master map.

«خلف كل مشروع ناجح، كيان»